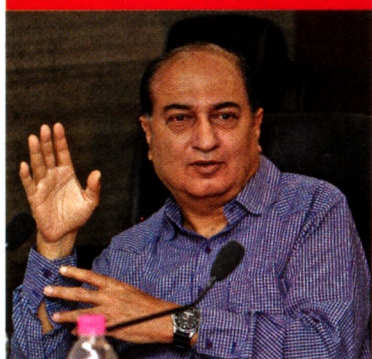


G. PARTHASARATHY



“ Pakistan is obfuscating and stalling. If it continues to instigate the Taliban, problems will continue for us.

Diplomatically, we have been defensive. We should have refused to answer Pakistan's 30 questions.

Within 72 hours of 26/11, India should have carried out precision military strikes against terrorist camps in Pakistan.

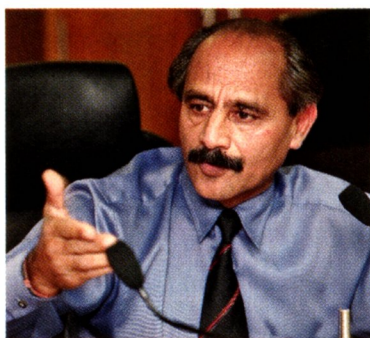
We don't act till the US pushes us. We usually allow Pakistan to hijack our agenda.

We expect the world to do everything for us, but we have not taken any diplomatic action to voice our anger. **”**

MAJ-GEN V. K. DATTA

“ We are facing a malaise that started with the Partition. We can't deal with Pakistan through five-year plans.

Strikes against Pakistan are difficult as the US forces have bases and logistic networks there.



Covert operations are about political will—the ability to do what the enemy is doing to you.

You cannot have the special forces proliferating all over. I am aghast the Government wants NSG units everywhere.

A single shot from a well-trained policeman armed with a .303 rifle can take out a terrorist carrying a bazooka. **”**

lack of coordination, lack of accountability, lack of equipment, lack of training—in fact there is lack of everything. The Government is again in a mood to shift the focus of public criticism from main issues by creating an agency, which will only be an investigative agency, and is not going to tackle the problem. They don't have a comprehensive law to tackle terror. The issue of equipment and training is being brushed aside. The agency has an officer who is not senior enough to get that kind of cooperation from the state and other agencies which he should.

G. Parthasarathy: In instances like 26/11, retribution must be immediate. There should have been precision strikes on terrorists' infrastructure in Pakistan within 72 hours. If Ajmal Kasab had not been captured, Pakistan would have gone into denial mode, which will prevail in future attacks. Diplomatically, we have been defensive. In fact, we should have refused to answer Pakistan's 30 questions. We are now in a situation where Pakistan is obfuscating. If the Pakistanis continue to instigate the Taliban who are fighting the Americans, and if the current state structure of Pakistan, dominated by its Army and ISI remains, this problem will continue for us.

We have let ourselves into a situation of being pushed by the Americans who want us to be sensitive to their agenda on Afghanistan. We should, in turn, tell them that you are fighting in a distant country that affects us and our security. We have allowed the Pakistanis to hijack that agenda and turn it against us. So, to that extent diplomacy has been unsuccessful. I don't think we have been aggressive enough in getting the Israelis to work and demand from the US Congress the trial of the accused in American courts. We don't have that kind of clout in the US. On the diplomatic side we have let the initiative slide to a situation where we are being told by the Americans that your deployment of forces is affecting our war in Afghanistan. Evidence by the Americans proves it is not just the ISI,